

CLIMATE & ENVIRONMENTAL CHANGE: VOCABULARY FOR A CHANGING WORLD



Climate & Environmental Change Terms



Climate Change

Long-term shifts in temperature, rainfall, and weather patterns on Earth.



Global Warming

The increase in Earth's average temperature caused by rising greenhouse gases.



Greenhouse Effect

A natural process where gases trap heat in Earth's atmosphere — made stronger by pollution.



Carbon Dioxide (CO₂)

A greenhouse gas produced by burning fossil fuels; major contributor to warming.



Extreme Weather

Severe weather events (heatwaves, floods, droughts, bushfires) that become more common as climate changes.



Living Things & Adaptation Terms



Ecosystem

A community of living things interacting with each other and their environment.



Habitat

The natural home or environment of a plant or animal.



Biodiversity

The variety of life in an ecosystem — different species, plants, and animals.



Adaptation

A feature or behaviour that helps a living thing survive in its environment.



Migration

Movement of animals to a different location due to seasonal changes or environmental pressures.

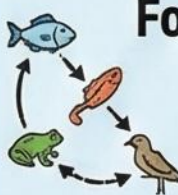


Extinction

When a species no longer exists.



Impact on Living Things



Food Web Disruption

Climate change can cause certain species to decline, affecting predators and prey.



Coral Bleaching

Corals lose their colour and health due to warmer ocean temperatures.



Habitat Loss

Changing temperatures, rising sea levels, and deforestation destroy habitats.



Lifecycle

Cloud protecting suahiot-nen-cologicat and premaiiry.



Drought Stress

Plants and animals struggle when water becomes limited.



Heat Stress

Higher temperatures affect animal behaviour, reproduction, and survival.



Human Actions & Solutions



Sustainability

Using resources wisely so they last for future generations.



Renewable Energy

Energy from sources that don't run out — solar, wind, hydro.



Conservation

Protecting and restoring natural environments.



Carbon Footprint

The amount of carbon emissions caused by a person, school, or activity.